The Sanen Kinsen Hiroku is one of the most celebrated texts in the history of Japanese market speculation. Composed around 1755 by Ushida Gonzaburo, an Osaka Dojima trader, it belongs to a genre of secret transmission texts that circulated among Edo-period trading houses.

The title alludes to the proverb of the three monkeys—"see no evil, hear no evil, speak no evil"—reinterpreted as a warning: do not be swayed by what you see others doing, what you hear as rumor, or what you say in haste. Instead, observe the deeper patterns.

This is the first English translation of the actual Sanen Kinsen Hiroku, made directly from the 1851 manuscript held at Kyoto University.

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Sanen Kinsen Hiroku

Three Monkeys Gold Spring Secret Record

A Secret Record on the Art of Rice Market Speculation

Edo Period, Japan

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